GLOBAL CHINA SEMINAR

China and the Russia–Ukraine War: Beyond the Headlines



Date: 5 August

Time: 5:00–6:00 pm

Venue: Alan MacDiarmid Room (AM103), Kelburn Campus

This presentation brings together findings from several of my research projects on China vis-à-vis the Russia–Ukraine war. Its central objective is to demonstrate the complexity of empirical reality, which is often obscured by overgeneralization, oversimplification, and the political agendas of commentatiors and researchers.

In particular, the presentation addresses a number of widely circulated assumptions regarding China vis-à-vis the ongoing Russia–Ukraine war, found in public discourse, especially in Western and Ukrainian media discourse, as well as in parts of the academic literature. In addition, it highlights some lesser-known aspects of China–Ukraine relations during the war. More broadly, the presentation advocates a rationalist approach to international relations and offers a non-traditional analytical lens in assessing the discussed events.



BIO

Dr Dima Romanenko

Visiting Research Fellow at the Contemporary China Research Centre, Victoria University of Wellington.

Dr Dima Romanenko holds a PhD in Media and Communication (University of Canterbury, Christchurch). He has a strong background in Chinese studies, with formal qualifications and over 10 years of professional experience in China. Between 2024 and 2026, he conducted a series of research projects on China vis-à-vis the Russia–Ukraine war, from which he will share key insights in this talk.

Register via ChinaCentre@vuw.ac.nz

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